

Pre-Reading

Essentials of Software Applications and OneDrive Setup

Gerrish School of Business · BUS123

Connect to Prior Knowledge

This is the first lesson of BUS123 — Solving Business Problems with Technology. You are beginning with a clean slate, which means the prior knowledge here is the everyday digital experience you already bring to the room: using a smartphone, saving files to a computer, logging into a school portal. This lesson builds directly on that familiarity and asks a sharper question: **are you using these tools casually, or professionally?** By the end of this module, you will have the foundation to answer confidently.

Core Concepts

What Is Microsoft 365?

Microsoft 365 is a subscription-based suite of productivity software that includes Excel, Word, PowerPoint, OneDrive, Outlook, and Teams. As an Endicott student, you have **full access at no cost** through your college account — which includes installing the desktop applications on up to five personal devices.

Application	Primary Purpose	Used In BUS123
Excel	Numerical data, calculations, financial analysis	Primary tool — every module
Word	Professional documents, reports, memos	Selected written deliverables
PowerPoint	Presentations, pitch decks, visual communication	Final project and selected activities
OneDrive	Cloud storage and file sync across all devices	Required for all file storage and submission

What Is OneDrive?

OneDrive is Microsoft's cloud storage and synchronization service. When you save a file to your OneDrive folder on your laptop, it is automatically copied to Microsoft's servers and made available on every other device connected to the same account. This means:

- **You can never truly "lose" the file** to a dead laptop — it lives in the cloud.
- **Every device stays current** — edit on your phone and the changes appear on your laptop.
- **Sharing is a link, not an attachment** — colleagues see the live version, not a stale copy.
- **Version history is automatic** — OneDrive saves prior versions so you can roll back mistakes.

Endicott-Specific Detail

Your Endicott College Microsoft account includes **1 TB of OneDrive storage**. This is separate from any personal Microsoft account you may already have. Always confirm you are signed in to your **@endicott.edu** account — not a personal Hotmail or Outlook.com account — before saving course files.

How OneDrive Sync Works

Understanding the sync process helps you avoid the most common submission mistake: submitting a file link before the file has actually finished uploading.

Icon	Status	What It Means	Safe to Submit?
■	Uploading	File is being sent to the cloud. Do not disconnect from internet.	No
■	Synced	File is safely stored in cloud and identical to your local copy.	Yes
■ ■	Error / Paused	Check internet connection. File has not been uploaded.	No

File Naming Convention

Every file you submit in BUS123 must follow the standard naming convention. This is not busywork — professional file organization is a skill employers expect on day one. A well-named file communicates ownership, purpose, and version at a glance.

Required format: LastName_FirstName_BUS123_ModuleN.xlsx

Example: Smith_Jordan_BUS123_Module01.xlsx

- **No spaces** — use underscores between every segment

- **Last name first** — enables alphabetical sorting in the gradebook
- **Zero-padded module numbers** — Module01, not Module1
- **Extension matches the application** — .xlsx, .docx, or .pdf
- **Never use:** "HW1", "final", "DONE", "v2", or first name only

Formula Reference

No Excel formulas are introduced in this lesson — it is focused on setup and orientation. The table below covers the **keyboard shortcuts and file operations** you will use repeatedly starting in class.

Action	Windows	Mac	When to Use
Save file	Ctrl + S	Cmd + S	Every few minutes while working
Save As	F12	Shift+Cmd+S	First save of a new file; renaming
Open file	Ctrl + O	Cmd + O	Opening an existing workbook from OneDrive
Undo	Ctrl + Z	Cmd + Z	Reverse any mistake immediately
New workbook	Ctrl + N	Cmd + N	Starting a new Excel file from scratch

Check Your Understanding

Answer each question on your own before checking the answer key at the end. These questions reflect the kind of conceptual checks you will see on Canvas quizzes.

Q1. What is the difference between saving a file to your local hard drive and saving it to OneDrive?

Q2. Name the three Microsoft 365 applications that will be used most in BUS123, and describe the primary business purpose of each.

Q3. A student saves an Excel file and immediately copies the OneDrive share link to submit on Canvas. The OneDrive icon in their system tray shows a spinning blue circle. What is the problem, and what should they do?

Q4. Write the correct file name for an Excel workbook submitted by a student named Taylor Reyes for Module 1 of BUS123.

Q5. Why does Endicott College have its own OneDrive account separate from a personal Microsoft account? What risk does mixing them create?

Q6. A classmate says they already have Microsoft Office from high school on their laptop. Is this sufficient for BUS123? What should they verify?

Q7. What does 'sync' mean in the context of OneDrive, and why does it matter for submitting assignments?

Key Vocabulary

Microsoft 365

A subscription-based suite of productivity applications including Excel, Word, PowerPoint, OneDrive, Outlook, and Teams. Available free to Endicott students through their college account.

OneDrive

Microsoft's cloud storage and file synchronization service. Files saved to OneDrive are backed up to the cloud and accessible from any device signed in to the same account.

Sync / Synchronization

The process by which OneDrive ensures the copy of a file on your local device matches the copy stored in the cloud. Indicated by a green checkmark when complete.

Desktop Application

A software program installed and running directly on your computer, as opposed to a browser-based version. Desktop apps have full features and work offline.

Cloud Storage

Files stored on remote servers accessed over the internet, rather than on a physical hard drive. Enables access from multiple devices and protects against local hardware failure.

File Naming Convention

A standardized format for naming files so they are identifiable, sortable, and consistent. In BUS123: LastName_FirstName_BUS123_ModuleN.xlsx.

Activation

The process of signing in to Microsoft 365 with your Endicott credentials to unlock full access to the desktop applications. Verified under File → Account in any Office app.

Version History

OneDrive's automatic record of prior saved states of a file. Allows you to restore an earlier version if content is accidentally deleted or overwritten.

Answer Key — Check Your Understanding

Q1

A local save stores the file only on that device — if the laptop is lost or breaks, the file is gone. Saving to OneDrive syncs the file to the cloud, making it accessible from any device and protected against hardware failure.

Q2

Excel — numerical data, calculations, and analysis. Word — professional writing, reports, and documents. PowerPoint — presentations, pitch decks, and visual communication.

Q3

The file is still uploading (blue circle = in progress). The instructor may receive an incomplete or inaccessible file. The student should wait for the green checkmark (fully synced) before copying the share link and submitting.

Q4

Reyes_Taylor_BUS123_Module01.xlsx — last name first, underscores between segments, zero-padded module number, .xlsx extension.

Q5

The school account is managed by Endicott IT, tied to your @endicott.edu credentials, and may have different storage limits and permissions. Mixing accounts risks saving course files to a personal account that may have

limited storage, or losing access when your school account is updated.

Q6

Not necessarily. They need to confirm: (1) the apps are the desktop version (not browser-only), (2) the account is activated with their Endicott credentials (File → Account), and (3) they have access to OneDrive under their school account. An old personal license may not include OneDrive integration or may be an outdated version.

Q7

Sync means the file on your local device and the copy stored in Microsoft's cloud are identical and up to date. It matters for submissions because Canvas links point to the cloud version — if the file hasn't synced, the instructor may see an older version or no file at all.